

Egg Salad Finger Sandwiches

Classic, creamy, and crowd-pleasing — a must for any proper tea spread.

Ingredients

- 8 large eggs
- 3 tbsp mayonnaise
- 1 tsp Dijon mustard
- 2 celery stalks, very finely minced
- 2 tbsp fresh chives, finely chopped
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 1/4 tsp white pepper
- 12 slices soft white or wheat bread (crusts removed)
- 2 tbsp unsalted butter, softened

Steps

1. Place 8 large eggs in a single layer in a saucepan, cover with cold water by 1 inch. Bring to a boil, then cover, remove from heat, and let sit 12 minutes. Transfer immediately to an ice bath for 10 minutes, then peel.
2. Chop peeled eggs finely — not too chunky, not paste-like. You want a cohesive mixture that won't fall out of the sandwich.
3. In a bowl, combine chopped eggs with 3 tbsp mayonnaise, 1 tsp Dijon mustard, 2 celery stalks, very finely minced, 2 tbsp fresh chives, finely chopped, 1/2 tsp salt, and 1/4 tsp white pepper. Stir gently to combine. Taste and adjust salt. Cover and refrigerate at least 30 minutes to let flavors meld.
4. Spread a thin layer of 2 tbsp unsalted butter, softened on all 12 slices soft white or wheat bread (crusts removed). Spoon a generous layer of egg salad onto half the slices, spreading evenly to the edges. Top with remaining bread slices and press gently.
5. Using a sharp serrated knife, cut each sandwich into 3 neat fingers. Wipe blade between

cuts. Arrange on a platter, garnish with a sprinkle of extra chives or a small sprig of dill if desired.

Notes

White pepper keeps the filling pretty and pale — black pepper leaves visible specks. The butter layer on the bread is the secret to elegant finger sandwiches; it prevents sogginess and adds richness. Egg salad can be made up to 24 hours ahead and stored covered in the fridge — assemble sandwiches the morning of the shower.